



ECHO

Pilot Programmatic Partnerships

Cash and voucher assistance

Giving cash to people affected by disasters is an effective, efficient and transparent way of providing humanitarian assistance to the most vulnerable. It ensures people have the freedom, dignity and independence to decide on their own recovery.

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Acronyms

- **AA** – Anticipatory Action
- **CVA** – Cash and Voucher Assistance
- **CWG** – Cash Working Group
- **DG ECHO** – Directorate-General for European Civil Protection and Humanitarian Aid Operations
- **DRM / DRR** – Disaster Risk Management / Disaster Risk Reduction
- **FSP** – Financial Service Provider
- **IFRC** – International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies
- **MEB** – Minimum Expenditure Basket
- **MPCA** – Multi-Purpose Cash Assistance
- **NS** – National Society
- **PECT** – Practical Emergency Cash Training
- **PGI** – Protection, Gender and Inclusion
- **PPP** – Pilot Programmatic Partnership

Who was there?			
Bangladesh Red Crescent Society		Cruz Roja Panama	
Honduran Red Cross		Cruz Roja Salvadoren	
Belgian Red Cross		Finnish Red Cross	
Cameroon Red Cross		Honduran Red Cross	
Croix Rouge Burkinabe		Niger Red Cross	
Croix Crouge Congolaise		Norwegian Red Cross	
Croix Rouge de la Republique Democratique du Congo		Red Crescent Society of Kyrgyzstan	
Croix Rouge du Tchad		Somali Red Crescent Society	
Croix Rouge Malienne		South Sudan Red Cross	
Cruz Roja Guatemala			
		The Netherlands Red Cross	
		Uganda Red Cross Society	
		Zambia Red Cross Society	
		International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies	

Executive Summary:

The Pilot Programmatic Partnership (PPP) between the International Federation of the Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC) and the Directorate-General of European Civil Protection and Humanitarian Aid Operations (DG ECHO) was a highly innovative programme implemented over three years with a global geographical scope that included twenty-five (25) National Societies (NS) across Africa, Asia Pacific, MENA, Europe and the Americas. These 25 National Red Cross Red Crescent Societies were partnered with thirteen (13) European Union National Societies (EUNS) in addition to country/cluster/regional delegations of the IFRC¹.

The geographical scope of the PPP extended to 25 countries across five regions as follows:

- **Africa:** Burkina Faso, Cameroon, Chad, the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC), Congo Brazzaville, Eswatini, Madagascar, Mali, Niger, Somalia, South Sudan, Uganda and Zambia.
- **Américas:** Ecuador, El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras and Panamá.
- **Asia-Pacific:** Bangladesh and Cambodia (year one only).
- **Europe:** Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan.
- **Middle East and North Africa:** Lebanon, Palestine, and Yemen.

Programme Overview:

The PPP involved the NSs of the 25 countries listed above - covering all five IFRC regions - with the 13 EUNSs working in a support role in the countries/regions, in addition to IFRC stakeholders at global, regional, and country levels. In terms of partnerships, DG ECHO has its primary office in Brussels and Technical Advisors (TA) in a majority of the 25 countries (some TA covered from a regional office, while others covered multiple countries from one country office).

The PPP was designed to make a concrete and large-scale contribution to the ambitions expressed in DG ECHO's Disaster Preparedness guidance² and complement the objective of *'supporting preparedness interventions to strengthen the capacity of in-country preparedness and response systems to act as locally and early as possible, by ensuring integration with sub-national and sub-regional disaster risk management systems.'*

¹ More information on this programme, its partners and its reach in 25 countries can be found at: <https://www.ifrc.org/get-involved/partner-us/multilaterals-and-international-financial-institutions/programmatic>

² https://ec.europa.eu/echo/files/policies/sectoral/dg_echo_guidance_note_-_disaster_preparedness_en.pdf

The PPP was officially launched on 1 April 2022 and was intended to run until 31 March 2025 with a budget of EUR 205M. A six-month inception phase involving ten NSs took place prior to formal programme launch, from September 2021-March 2022, to test the concept and begin to assess the needed coordination and cooperation arrangements.

A three-month no-cost extension was granted by DG ECHO to extend the programme completion date to 30 June 2025, with a four-month reporting period of July-October 2025. All of PPP's activities are founded on the IFRC Strategy 2030, and the strategic priorities and targets are highlighted in IFRC's Plan and Budget 2021-2025³, as agreed with DG ECHO, to ensure a strategic approach to programming.

The overall programmatic objective of the PPP was to ensure communities and individuals are taking action to anticipate, prepare for, and respond to and recover from humanitarian and health crises. Central to the PPP was its Theory of Change (ToC) that focused on five Pillars aiming to enable the strengthening of NS' auxiliary role and operational capacity. The five pillars were:

- Pillar 1: **Disaster Risk Management:** institutions are prepared to effectively anticipate, respond, and recover from the impact of evolving and multiple shocks and hazards.
- Pillar 2: **Epidemic and pandemic preparedness and response:** Communities, NSs and other key stakeholders, are better prepared to prevent, detect, and respond to epidemics.
- Pillar 3: **Humanitarian assistance and protection for people on the move:** Displaced persons and migrants in vulnerable situations have access to humanitarian assistance and protection in a safe, accountable, and participatory manner.
- Pillar 4: **Cash and voucher assistance (CVA):** People affected by crises and disasters have their basic needs met through multi-purpose cash assistance that is timely and adequate.
- Pillar 5: **Risk communication, community engagement, and accountability:** People and communities, vulnerable to, and affected by humanitarian and public health crises, can actively participate in decisions affecting them.

³ <https://www.ifrc.org/sites/default/files/Plan-and-Budget-promo-doc-FINAL.pdf>

In addition, the PPP framework included *five cross-cutting areas*: **Anticipatory Action, Climate-smart programming, Environmental sustainability, Legal frameworks, and Digital transformation**, and sought to have an impact on broader humanitarian sector objectives through a concerted focus on:

- *Localisation of aid*: centred on NS' priorities, needs, and capacities.
- *Coordination*: demonstrating cohesive structures, mechanisms and processes whereby IFRC network-wide action can be a catalyst and create sustainable linkages with other actors.
- *Accountability*: creating fit-for-purpose standards for planning, monitoring, and reporting – which institutionalises transparency, a result-based approach and shared responsibility, complementarity of roles
- *Nexus approach*: constituting the backbone of preparedness and resilience by creating synergies and common goals across short-term emergency response programme and longer-term development actions.

The non-programmatic PPP objectives were manifold:

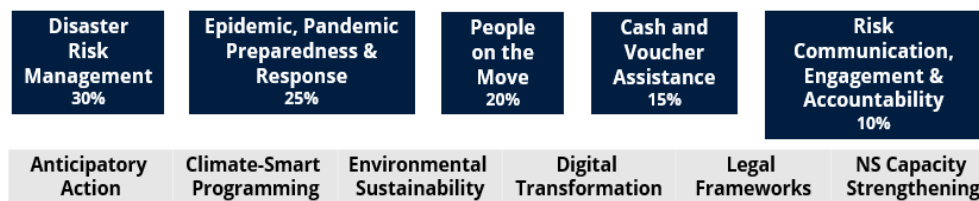
- To deliver on the localisation commitments of the Grand Bargain⁴.
- To match field realities of protracted crises with longer term predictable funding, facilitating actions and processes with greater impact; and the necessary time.
- To leverage the global IFRC network capacities and unique access to people and communities.
- To contribute to the ambitions of the European Union (EU) to become the biggest donor for international aid in the world and towards IFRC Strategy 2030.
- To increase efficiencies through economies of scale i.e. not a collection of projects.
- To support implementation of the IFRC network-wide Way of Working (NWOW), through a concrete joint initiative of the IFRC, EUNS with DG ECHO Certification and NSs of countries of implementation.

The Global Component

The PPP also incorporated the **Global Component** (GC), in order to further strengthen the quality, efficiency and effectiveness of the actions being implemented in the 25 countries and to seek alignment among countries on a technical level.

⁴ <https://interagencystandingcommittee.org/grand-bargain>

The Programme - showing the Global Component and the cross-cutting issues



The GC is grounded on existing IFRC thematic/sectoral strategies, approaches and tools, and technical resources across the five Pillars of action and the cross-cutting issues. It also reflects IFRC efforts to ensure an integrated and systemic approach to reinforcing local action by its members, which requires NSs to be strong institutions, well placed in their domestic environment and with ability to deliver and partner with others. Through a multi-pronged approach, the GC also facilitates tailored and contextual integration of the cross-cutting issues mentioned above and highlighted in the PPP ToC (Anticipatory action, Climate smart programming, Environmental sustainability, Legal frameworks, and Digital transformation).

The ambition for the PPP is that all National Societies involved in the Action will have embarked in a more structured and systematic preparedness process and taken actions to enhance their response capacity priorities, that will allow them to provide relevant, timely and quality humanitarian programs and services. As such, A National Society that is prepared to effectively respond to any type of disaster and crisis in its national territory has a clear role and mandate within the national disaster management system; has emergency procedures and systems in place ready to be activated in a crisis; has its staff and volunteers trained to support their communities to anticipate risks, provide information, engage in surveillance activities, carry out community awareness and school education activities, support local authorities with the evacuation of people, provide first aid, respond to basic needs through in kind or cash distribution, among others, in coordination with local authorities and partners.

To improve efficiency and dignity in aid delivery, the PPP mainstreamed Cash and Voucher Assistance (CVA) as a key response modality.

1. CVA and cross-pillar contribution:

Cash and Voucher Assistance has become a cornerstone modality of the ECHO PPP. During the first 3.5 years of the roll-out, nearly all National Societies included under the PPP implemented multipurpose cash assistance to help vulnerable households meet their most pressing food and non-food needs. This marked a significant shift away from reliance on in-kind aid and demonstrated the ability of National Societies to deliver cash at scale and in line with international donor expectations.

1.1. Cross Pillars Linkage to Result 4:

The table below demonstrates the cross-pillar integration of Cash and Voucher Assistance across the 20 National Societies engaged under the ECHO PPP 2025:

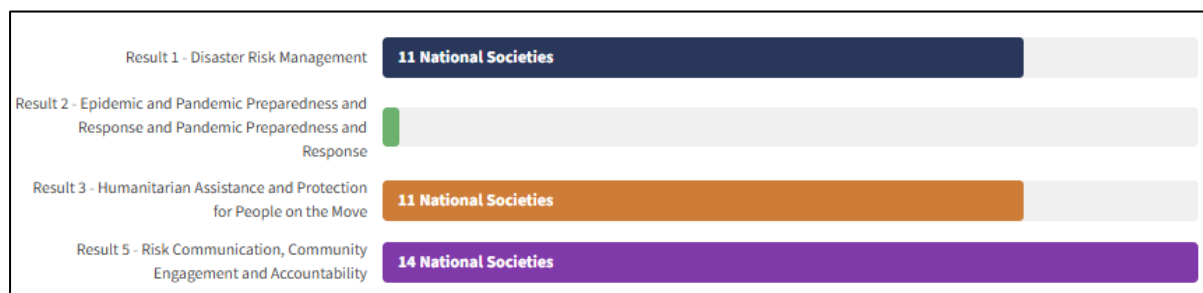
COUNTRY	R1	R2	R3	R5	TOTAL
Burkina Faso	✓	-	-	✓	2
Cameroon	-	-	-	✓	1
Republic of Congo	✓	-	-	-	1
Democratic Republic of the Congo	-	-	✓	✓	2
Ecuador	✓	-	✓	✓	3
El Salvador	-	-	✓	-	1
Eswatini	✓	-	-	✓	2
Guatemala	✓	-	✓	✓	3
Honduras	-	-	✓	✓	2
Kyrgyzstan	✓	-	-	-	1
Madagascar	✓	-	-	✓	2
Mali	-	-	✓	-	1
Niger	✓	-	✓	✓	3
Palestine	-	-	✓	✓	2
Somalia	✓	-	-	-	1
South Sudan	✓	-	-	-	1
Chad	✓	-	✓	✓	3
Tajikistan	-	-	✓	✓	2
Uganda	-	-	✓	✓	2
Zambia	✓	-	-	✓	2
Lebanon (delivery only)	-	-	-	-	-

- **Result 5 (Risk Communication, Community Engagement and Accountability)** engaged the highest number of National Societies at **14**, reflecting strong institutional investment in CVA capacity building, Standard Operating Procedures, digital tools adoption, and Cash Working Group leadership across the portfolio.

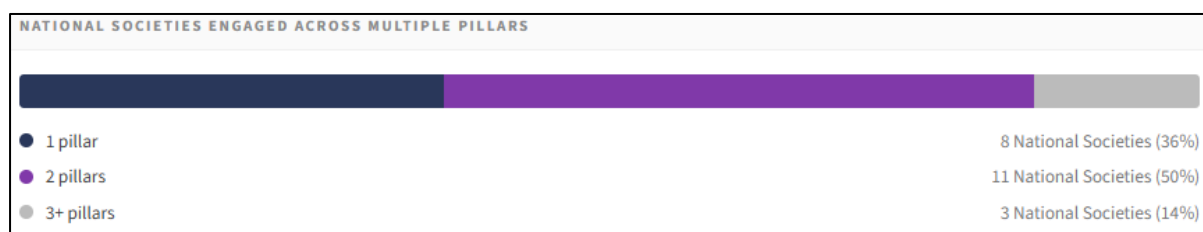
- **Result 1 (Disaster Risk Management)** and **Result 3 (Humanitarian Assistance and Protection for People on the Move)** each engaged **11 National Societies**, confirming CVA's dual role as both a preparedness and response tool in disaster contexts, and a protection mechanism for displaced and mobile populations.

- **Result 2 (Epidemic and Pandemic Preparedness and Response)** recorded no confirmed CVA delivery during the reporting period.

In terms of cross-pillar engagement, **8 National Societies** contributed to a single result pillar, while **11** engaged across two pillars and **3** — Ecuador, Guatemala, and Chad — contributed across three pillars, reflecting the most advanced levels of CVA mainstreaming within their programmes.



As shown above, the majority of National Societies (50%) engaged across two result pillars, while 36% contributed to a single pillar and 14% — Ecuador, Guatemala, and Chad — engaged across three or more pillars, demonstrating a growing trend of cross-pillar CVA integration within National Society programmes.



Result Impact Summary:

Result 1 — Disaster Risk Management CVA was deployed across 11 National Societies as a preparedness and response tool, supporting contingency planning, anticipatory action, and emergency cash distributions — shortening response times and strengthening resilience within national DRM frameworks.

Result 2 — Epidemic and Pandemic Preparedness and Response No confirmed CVA delivery was recorded under this result pillar. Epidemic preparedness activities were carried out through non-cash modalities.

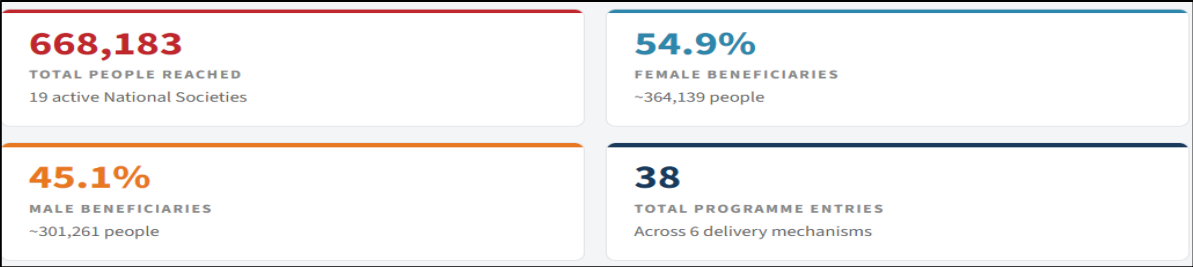
RESULT PILLAR IMPACT SUMMARY	
RESULT 1 - DISASTER RISK MANAGEMENT	CVA used as preparedness and response tool. Shortened response times, supported early action and resilience.
RESULT 2 - EPIDEMIC AND PANDEMIC PREPAREDNESS AND RESPONSE	No confirmed CVA delivery under epidemic response during the reporting period.
RESULT 3 - HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE AND PROTECTION FOR PEOPLE ON THE MOVE	CVA integrated with protection services. Promoted safe, rights-based humanitarian assistance and self-reliance.
RESULT 5 - RISK COMMUNICATION, COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT AND ACCOUNTABILITY	CVA institutionalized as core NS competency. NSs positioned as cash-ready actors beyond PPP cycle.

Result 3 — Humanitarian Assistance and Protection for People on the Move CVA was integrated with protection services across 11 National Societies, providing flexible assistance to migrants, refugees, and displaced persons — reducing dependency on in-kind aid and promoting rights-based humanitarian response.

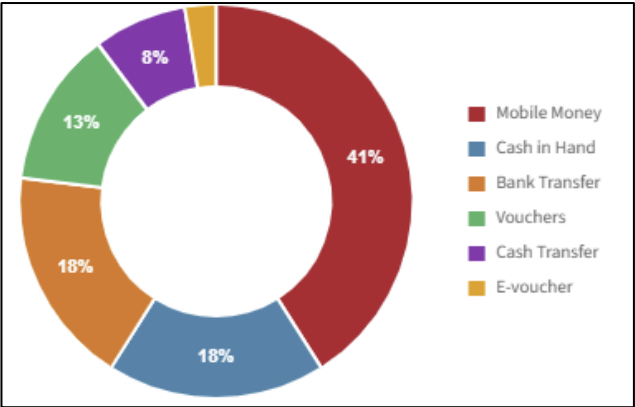
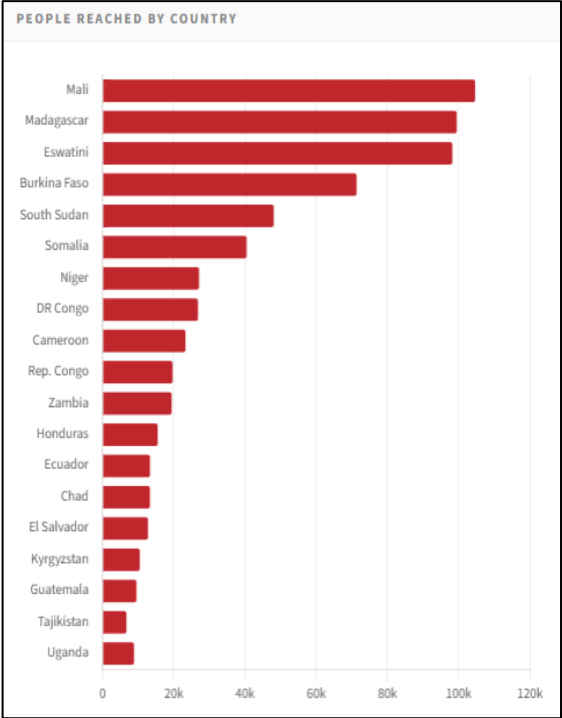
Result 5 — Risk Communication, Community Engagement and Accountability CVA was institutionalised as a core competency across 14 National Societies through SOPs, roadmaps, FSP agreements, Cash Working Group leadership, and digital tools — positioning National Societies as cash-ready actors beyond the PPP cycle.

1. Delivery Mechanism and FSP:

A total of **668,183 people** were reached across **19 active National Societies**, with **38 programme entries** recorded spanning **6 delivery mechanisms**. The majority of beneficiaries were female, accounting for **54.9%** (~364,139 people), while male beneficiaries represented **45.1%** (~301,261 people).



- **Mali** recorded the highest reach at **104,591 people**, followed by **Madagascar** at **99,427** and **Eswatini** at **98,202** — together accounting for nearly 46% of the total people reached across the portfolio.
- **Burkina Faso** (71,322) and **South Sudan** (48,036) rounded out the top five, both reflecting large-scale multipurpose cash responses to floods and displacement.
- In the mid-range, **Somalia** (40,422), **Niger** (27,057), and **Democratic Republic of the Congo** (26,766) reflect sustained cash programming in complex, fragile, and conflict-affected contexts.
- Smaller programmes in **Kyrgyzstan** (10,432), **Guatemala** (9,486), **Tajikistan** (6,674), and **Uganda** (to be verified) reflect more targeted interventions, while remaining critical to building National Society CVA capacity in those contexts.



Mobile Money was the dominant delivery mechanism, accounting for **41%** of all programme entries across the portfolio, reflecting a strong and sustained shift towards digital and mobile-based cash delivery. **Cash in Hand** and **Bank Transfer** each represented **18%**, remaining essential modalities in contexts with limited

mobile connectivity or where direct physical distribution was operationally required. **Vouchers** accounted for **13%** of programmes, applied primarily in protection-sensitive and market-based intervention contexts. **Cash Transfer** represented **8%** and **E-voucher** accounted for the remaining **3%**, together highlighting the diversity of delivery modalities deployed to meet varying operational, contextual, and beneficiary needs across National Societies under the ECHO PPP.

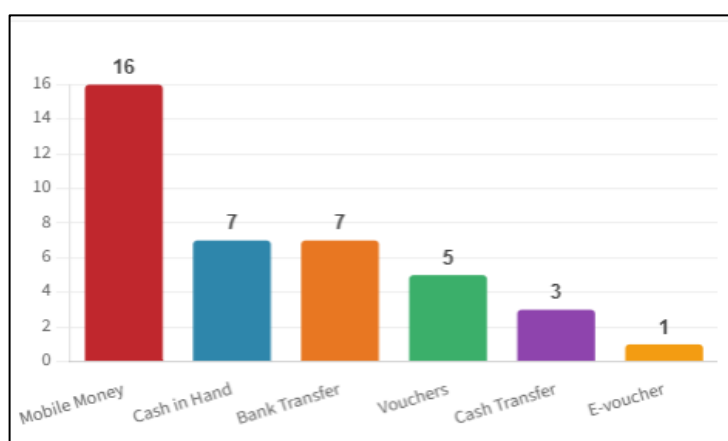
COUNTRY AND DELIVERY MECHANISM		
COUNTRY	DELIVERY MECHANISM(S)	TOTAL PEOPLE REACHED
Mali	Mobile Money	104,591
Madagascar	Cash Direct Through Agents	99,427
Eswatini	Mobile Money	98,202
Burkina Faso	Cash Transfer E-voucher	71,322
South Sudan	Cash in Hand / Envelope	48,036
Somalia	Mobile Money	40,422
Niger	Mobile Money (Nita-Money) Vouchers	27,057
Democratic Republic of the Congo	Mobile Money Vouchers	26,766
Cameroon	Mobile Money Bank Transfer Agent-based Cash	23,245
Republic of Congo	Cash in Hand	19,625
Zambia	Mobile Money (Airtel) Bank Transfer (ZANACO) Cash in Hand	19,367
Honduras	Mobile Money / Electronic Codes Vouchers / Gift Cards	15,451
Ecuador	Mobile Money Vouchers	13,283
Chad	Mobile Money (Airtel) Vouchers	13,274
El Salvador	Vouchers / Gift Cards	12,726
Kyrgyzstan	Bank Transfer Vouchers	10,432
Guatemala	Bank Transfer Cash in Hand Vouchers / Gift Cards	9,486
Tajikistan	Cash in Envelope Bank Transfer Vouchers / Prepaid Cards	6,674
Uganda	Mobile Money	8,797

The table above provides a summary of delivery mechanisms utilised by each National Society alongside the total number of people reached:

- **Mobile Money** was the most widely used mechanism, deployed by Mali, Madagascar, Eswatini, Somalia, Cameroon, Zambia, Honduras, Ecuador, Chad, and Kyrgyzstan — reflecting strong digital financial infrastructure and National Society capacity to leverage mobile payment systems.
- **Vouchers** were utilised across multiple contexts including Niger, Honduras, Ecuador, Chad, El Salvador, Guatemala, and Tajikistan — particularly in protection and market-based response settings for migrants and displaced populations.
- **Bank Transfer** was used in South Sudan, Niger, Democratic Republic of Congo, Zambia, Ecuador, El Salvador, Kyrgyzstan, Guatemala, and Tajikistan — primarily in contexts with established banking infrastructure and formal Financial Service Provider agreements.
- **Cash in Hand** remained an essential modality in Republic of Congo, South Sudan, Niger, Mali, Zambia, Chad, Guatemala, and Tajikistan — deployed in contexts with

limited digital connectivity or where direct cash distribution was the most appropriate and dignified option.

- **Cash Transfer and E-voucher** were utilised specifically in **Burkina Faso**, where the security context necessitated more controlled distribution mechanisms.
- **Cash Direct Through Agents** was confirmed for **Madagascar**, reflecting a locally adapted delivery approach aligned with community structures and accessibility constraints.



The Bar chart illustrates the distribution of delivery mechanisms by number of programme entries across the portfolio. Mobile Money recorded the highest number of entries at 16, confirming its dominance as the primary cash delivery modality across the portfolio. Cash in Hand and Bank Transfer each recorded 7 entries, followed by Vouchers at 5, Cash Transfer at 3, and E-voucher at 1 — reflecting the diversity of modalities deployed to meet varying operational and contextual needs across National Societies.

5, Cash Transfer at 3, and E-voucher at 1 — reflecting the diversity of modalities deployed to meet varying operational and contextual needs across National Societies.



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Pillar 4: Cash and Voucher Assistance (CVA)



Thematic Area Cash and Voucher Assistance	Initiative Signing of Global Framework Agreements 2025	Objectives & Key Takeaways In 2025, the IFRC signed global framework agreements for data management and payment service providers. These new agreements will help boost the speed, flexibility, and reach of our cash and voucher assistance in emergencies, offering more choice and dignity for people in need. New Payment service providers - RedRose - integrated with MoneyGram for cash pick-up, mobile money, bank transfers, eVouchers. This service has been used extensively in response to the Ukraine and Impacted Countries Operation already and more recently in the Americas region. - Yordex - prepaid cards and bank transfers - Mastercard - cash pick-up, bank transfers, mobile money and push to card New Data Management Providers - RedRose - Manages programme and data of people served with Cash and Vouchers Assistance, in-kind, and Services 121 - User-friendly tool designed to streamline CVA process
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Cash and Voucher Assistance & Digital Transformation

Webinar: Digitalisation & Integrated Assistance | 2025

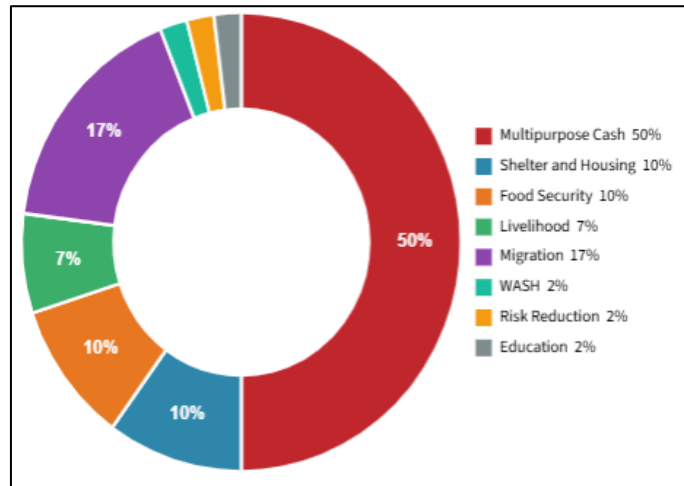
A webinar on digitalisation and integrated assistance was organised by the GVA CVA and DT teams for the leadership of Central Asia National Societies. The objective was to raise awareness among National Society leaders about digitalised and integrated approaches to Cash and Voucher Assistance (CVA) and beyond. These approaches are essential for enhancing the speed, accountability, and overall impact of CVA interventions.

Public

*Note: Palestine Red Crescent Society completed its **first-ever CVA distribution** in June 2025 (West Bank, Tulkarem branch) — a landmark achievement during the three-year PPP cycle, followed by a Post-Distribution Monitoring exercise and lessons learned session. This milestone was built on the **PER self-assessment conducted in Year 1**, a critical institutional step in assessing CVA readiness. While the programme file experienced delays due to the **escalating conflict in Gaza and the West Bank**, the National Society's commitment remained steadfast — positioning Palestine Red Crescent Society as a cash-ready actor for future humanitarian responses.*

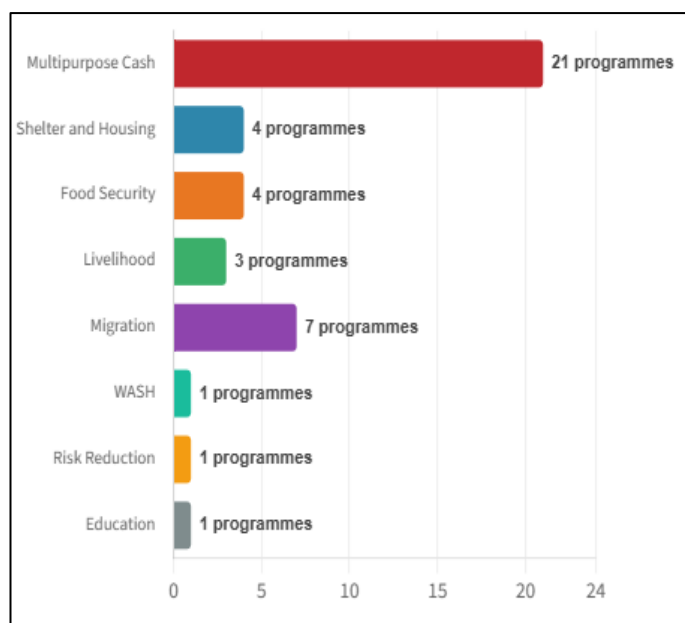
2. Project Objective (Sectoral of CVA):

Multipurpose Cash dominated the portfolio at **50%**, confirming its role as the primary modality across the majority of National Societies. **Shelter, Housing and Settlements** accounted for **10%**, followed by **Food Security** at **10%**, reflecting CVA's strong application in post-disaster recovery and immediate nutritional needs. **Livelihood** and **Migration and Displacement Cash** each represented **17%**, highlighting cash assistance's growing role in economic resilience and people-on-the-move responses. **Water, Sanitation and Hygiene, Risk Reduction and Climate Adaptation** and **Education** each represented **2%** demonstrating the breadth of sectoral deployment across National Societies under the ECHO PPP.



The chart illustrates the distribution of CVA programme entries across sectors:

- **Multipurpose Cash** recorded the highest number of entries at **21**, confirming its role as the universal baseline modality across all contexts.
- **Migration and Displacement Cash** followed with **7 entries**, reflecting CVA's significant application in protection-focused responses for people on the move.
- **Shelter and Housing** and **Food Security** each recorded **4 entries**, supporting post-disaster recovery and immediate nutritional needs.
- **Livelihood** accounted for **3 entries** across Ecuador, Eswatini, and Chad.
- **WASH, Risk Reduction and Climate Adaptation**, and **Education** each recorded **1 entry**, demonstrating the breadth of sectoral deployment across National Societies under the ECHO PPP.



The table below provides a detailed mapping of CVA programme entries by sector and the corresponding National Societies involved, complementing the distribution shown in the charts above.

SECTOR AND COUNTRY MAPPING		
SECTOR	PROGRAMMES	COUNTRIES
Multipurpose Cash	21	Burkina Faso, Cameroon, Republic of Congo, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Ecuador, Guatemala, Honduras, Kyrgyzstan, Madagascar, Mali, Niger, El Salvador, Somalia, South Sudan, Eswatini, Chad, Tajikistan, Uganda, Zambia
Shelter, Housing and Settlements	4	Burkina Faso, Madagascar, Mali, Chad
Food Security	4	Honduras, Madagascar, Somalia, Zambia
Livelihood	3	Ecuador, Eswatini, Chad
Migration and Displacement Cash	7	Honduras, El Salvador, Ecuador, Guatemala, Tajikistan, Uganda, South Sudan
Water, Sanitation and Hygiene	1	Honduras
Risk Reduction, Climate Adaptation and Recovery	1	Guatemala
Education	1	Honduras

Note: The 20 programme entries reflect 18 implementing National Societies, as Burkina Faso and Tajikistan each recorded two entries due to the simultaneous use of multiple delivery mechanisms within their programmes.

Highlights:

1. Inbada: Women's Insights on cash Aid in Lubulini, Eswatini

A participatory video documenting lessons learned from women in Lubulini on the multi-purpose cash assistance implemented under the DG ECHO-funded Pilot Programmatic Partnership (PPP), supporting their livelihood protection activities. Here is the link for the video:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0WvO935qCAQ&list=PLrI6tpZ6pQmQZsKuQl6n4ELEdiVqHGFw2>

2. Somalia Nutrition Programme

Cash for Nutrition (CfN) Program:

- Somalia implemented a targeted Cash for Nutrition program showing **over 80% improvement in nutritional status** for enrolled children and pregnant/lactating women (PLW)
- The program specifically targeted malnourished children under 5 and PLW, requiring beneficiaries to visit health centers monthly for nutritional status checks, supplements, and treatment

- Cash assistance was conditional but unrestricted, with conditionality requiring monthly visits to health centers
- 650 households benefited in Puntland and 700 in Somaliland
- Post-Distribution Monitoring showed 99% of households noted the assistance improved their access to nutritious food and water

3. Honduras School Supplies Vouchers for Returnee Children

Vouchers for Displaced and Returnee Children:

- Honduran Red Cross distributed **vouchers for school supplies to promote school reintegration of displaced indigenous children and children in high-risk areas**
- 242 children in the José Simón Azcona Primary School received vouchers (approximately 60 EUR) to buy school supplies
- This intervention was in Las Palmas community, Tegucigalpa, an area with high social risks due to criminal groups
- The program specifically targeted school reintegration, with teachers reporting that assistance lowered dropout rates and maintained school attendance

Eswatini: Cash and Voucher Assistance for Flood-Affected Communities

Cash Assistance for Flood Recovery — Protection and Gender-Sensitive Approach:

In Eswatini, the Baphalali Red Cross Society delivered mobile money transfers to flood-affected households under the ECHO PPP, prioritizing women-headed households, GBV survivors, and caregivers of orphaned children. Recipients used assistance to repair homes, restock food, and avoid predatory lenders — reflecting CVA's dignity-centered, flexible approach.

Key Lessons Learned:

- Embed PGI principles across all programme stages to address the needs of women, children, persons with disabilities, and other vulnerable groups.
- Build trusted, accessible feedback mechanisms that genuinely reach all community segments.
- Close the feedback loop — when beneficiaries in one farming community flagged that seeds were unsuited to local conditions, the Red Cross sourced appropriate varieties, improving outcomes and reinforcing community trust.




Funded by the European Union

Pillar 4: Cash and Voucher Assistance (CVA)

Thematic Area	Initiative	Objectives & Key Takeaways
Cash and Voucher Assistance	Country Highlights 2025	Palestine Red Crescent: The NS' CVA preparedness pathway was implemented as planned between 2022 and October 2023. Following a shift in NS' priorities and a pause in the CVA, the National Society managed to carry out a CVA programme pilot in June 2025, and, in a challenging context, distributed cash for basic needs to IDP's in North West-Bank's most affected cities, which was a significant accomplishment. Burkina Faso Red cross: Despite a nation-wide suspension on the use of CVA, the National Society managed to do CVA for shelter items through vouchers. This was done thanks to the NS innovative and inclusive approach. The targeted region local authorities were engaged in the process from the initial stages of the programme till distribution which helped build trust to overcome reluctance from authorities and communities. Cameroun Red Cross: The NS undertook its first CVA preparedness self-assessment in June and the NS also used Red Rose for CVA data management. This marks its first use of a digitalised platform in its CVA delivery.

3. Capacity Building:

Under the ECHO PPP, IFRC significantly strengthened National Society (NS) capacity to design, deliver, and scale Cash and Voucher Assistance (CVA) through a combination of structured training, practical testing, peer exchange, and coordination mechanisms.

Targeted Training and Tools Development: Generic post-distribution monitoring (PDM) tools and—including support services staff—were developed and delivered to French-speaking NSs across the Africa region. The generic PDM tool was piloted by Cameroon Red Cross and El Salvador Red Cross within their PPP CVA operations, supporting harmonized monitoring approaches and operational learning across regions. In parallel, a dedicated **Protection, Gender and Inclusion (PGI) in CVA** online training course was developed in English for the Africa region, with plans for translation into French and other languages and phased deployment to additional regions by 2027.

Regional Peer Exchange and Knowledge Sharing: To reinforce learning and test systems under real-world conditions, **more than 10 NSs conducted live-scenario CVA simulations**. These exercises enabled NSs to identify and address operational gaps—particularly in data verification processes and Financial Service Provider (FSP) contracting timelines—prior to large-scale implementation, strengthening preparedness and risk mitigation.

Peer support – with the support of Burundi Red Cross CVA officer, Congo Brazzaville conducted its last CVA activities in February 2025.

Regional Peer Exchange:

- **Americas:** El Salvador workshop harmonized PDM tools for all PPP countries; Panama, Ecuador, El Salvador conducted migration-sensitive CVA exchanges
- **Africa:** 26 participants from 11 NSs discussed feedback mechanisms and CEA institutionalization; Niger & Chad exchanged conflict-context cash experiences

Training

- Central Asia: First-ever regional PECT training in Almaty brought together Red Cross/RC staff, Rapid Response teams, Cash teams, and surge experts
- Uganda workshop CVA and AA - 2024
- PECT in Cameroon for French Speaking - 2024
- PECT for English speaking in Uganda - 2024
- CVA Core skill training in DRC in June 2023

Coordination and Leadership

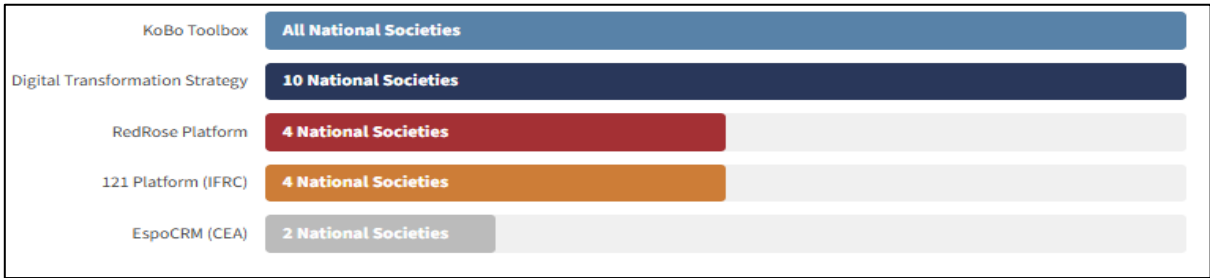
At the coordination level, NS engagement in national and regional Cash Working Groups was reinforced, contributing to alignment with inter-agency standards and government systems. Somalia Red Crescent Society's role in chairing the East Africa

CVA cluster further demonstrated strengthened leadership and auxiliary roles within national humanitarian coordination structures.

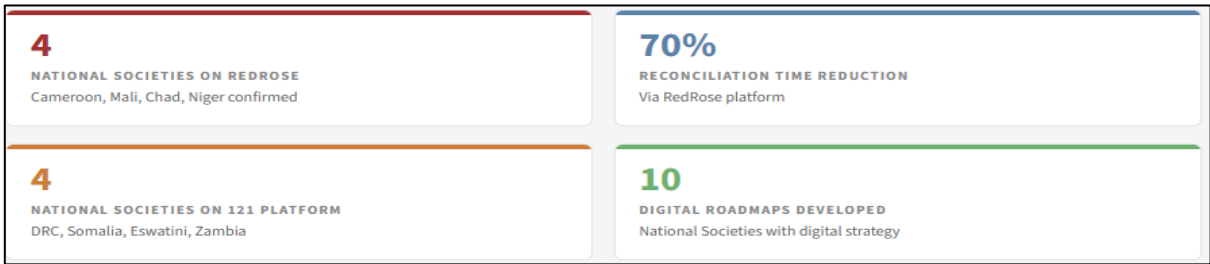
Overall Outcome

Collectively, these investments enhanced institutional CVA capacity, improved operational readiness, strengthened peer networks, and positioned NSs as credible and capable partners in coordinated, protection-sensitive cash responses under the ECHO PPP.

3.1. Digitalization:

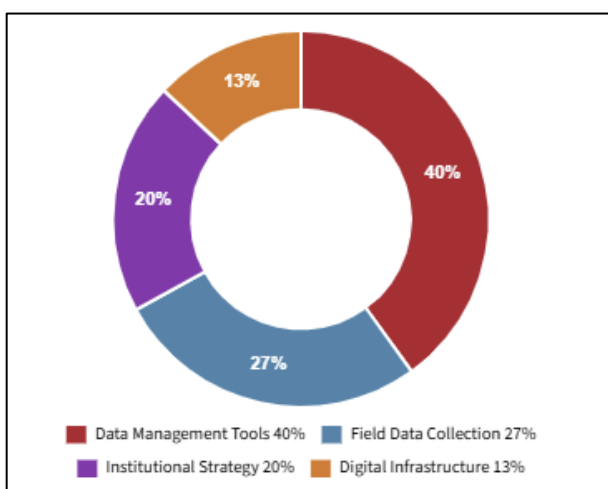


KoBo Toolbox was universally adopted across **all National Societies** as the standard field data collection tool for needs assessments, beneficiary registration, and post-distribution monitoring. **Digital Transformation Strategy** was developed by **10 National Societies**, reflecting strong institutional commitment to long-term digital capacity. **RedRose Platform** was confirmed by **4 National Societies**, delivering significant improvements in cash distribution tracking and reconciliation. **121 Platform (IFRC)** was deployed by **4 National Societies** for payment processing and Financial Service Provider integration. **EspoCRM** was utilised by **2 National Societies** — Madagascar for CVA data management and Uganda for community feedback mechanisms under the CEA approach.



Highlights:

- **4 National Societies** confirmed RedRose adoption (Cameroon, Mali, Chad, Niger) as their primary beneficiary management and cash distribution platform.
- **70% reduction** in reconciliation time reported through RedRose deployment, significantly improving operational efficiency and accountability.
- **4 National Societies** utilising the 121 Platform (Democratic Republic of the Congo, Somalia, Eswatini, Zambia) for mobile payment processing and beneficiary registration.
- **10 National Societies** developed digital transformation strategies and roadmaps, reflecting strong institutional commitment to long-term digital capacity building.



Data Management Tools accounted for the largest share of digital investment at **40%**, driven by RedRose and 121 Platform deployments across National Societies. **Field Data Collection** represented **27%**, underpinned by the universal adoption of KoBo Toolbox as the standard data collection platform. **Institutional Strategy** accounted for **20%**, reflected in the digital transformation roadmaps developed across 10 National Societies.

Digital Infrastructure represented the remaining **13%**, covering connectivity upgrades, GIS systems, and community feedback mechanisms.

The table below provides a detailed overview of digital tools deployed across participating National Societies and their key impacts:

- **KoBo Toolbox** was adopted universally, enabling offline field data collection for needs assessments and post-distribution monitoring across all National Societies.
- **RedRose** was confirmed across **4 National Societies** — Cameroon, Mali, Chad, and Niger — delivering a significant reduction in reconciliation time and strengthening real-time field monitoring and beneficiary registration.
- **121 Platform (IFRC)** supported **4 National Societies** — Democratic Republic of the Congo, Somalia, Eswatini, and Zambia — providing clean data hosting, payment processing, and Financial Service Provider system integration.
- **EspoCRM** was utilised by **2 National Societies** — Madagascar for CVA beneficiary data management, and Uganda for community feedback mechanisms linked to the CEA approach via the 510 Initiative.
- **Custom CVA Information Management System** was developed by **Uganda** in collaboration with the Netherlands Red Cross 510 Initiative, piloted in Sironko district to streamline beneficiary registration, data management, and cash disbursement.

DIGITAL TOOLS AND COUNTRY DEPLOYMENT			
TOOL / PLATFORM	NATIONAL SOCIETIES	COUNTRIES	KEY IMPACT
KoBo Toolbox	All	All participating National Societies	Universal field data collection; offline registration for needs assessments and post-distribution monitoring
RedRose	4	Cameroon, Mali, Chad, Niger (all confirmed from country reports)	Streamlined cash distribution tracking, real-time field monitoring and beneficiary registration
121 Platform (IFRC)	4	Democratic Republic of the Congo (switched from RedRose), Somalia, Eswatini, Zambia	Mobile payment processing, beneficiary registration and CVA information management
EspoCRM	2	Madagascar (CVA management), Uganda (CEA feedback mechanism via 510 Initiative)	Beneficiary data management and community accountability tracking
Custom CVA IM System (510)	1	Uganda (built with Netherlands Red Cross 510 Initiative)	CVA Information Management System launched; piloted in Sironko district - streamlines registration, data management and cash disbursement

3.2. Technical Working Group (TWGs) and Coordination:

Purpose and Institutionalization:

Coordination mechanisms, particularly Cash Working Groups (CWGs) and interagency platforms, were central to achieving efficiency, alignment, and institutional strengthening across the PPP. Coordination efforts aimed to institutionalize CVA capacity, standardize procedures, and ensure that NSs functioned as key partners within national humanitarian systems.

- **Harmonization and Alignment:** Participation in CWGs and TWGs built a common language across agencies, aligning transfer values, Minimum Expenditure Baskets (MEBs), and beneficiary criteria with government and humanitarian partners.
- **Auxiliary Role Strengthening:** These roles strengthened the auxiliary status of NSs, positioning them as national conveners in CVA and DRM.
- **Transparency and Efficiency:** Coordination reinforced transparency, helped avoid duplication, optimized resource use, and facilitated joint planning.

Key Coordination Structures and NS Leadership:

Cash Working Group (CWGs):

- **Niger:** Co-chaired the national CWG with WFP.
- **Cameroon:** Chaired the sub-regional CWG (Central Africa).
- **Zambia:** Co-chair with UNCHR and WFP.
- **Eswatini:** Co-leading with WFP, World Vision, and NDMA.
- **El Salvador:** Active and sustained participation in the Cash Transfer Working Group (GMTE).
- **Guatemala:** Active participation in the Multisectoral Cash Transfer Group (GMTM).
- **Uganda:** Active co-chairing of the National CWG.
- **Tajikistan:** Active participation in the Inter-Agency Cash Working Group.

Key Activities:

- Defining and revising the Minimum Expenditure Basket (MEB).
- Harmonizing transfer values and operational criteria.
- Sharing operational data (5weeks reporting).

4. Dubai Workshop Lesson Learned:

The table below synthesizes the key strategic insights and agreed priorities emerging from the workshop, highlighting how CVA under Result 4 is strengthening anticipatory, coordinated, and cross-sectoral humanitarian responses while informing longer-term system and policy integration.

CVA as the Backbone of Anticipatory Action (AA)	
Key Insight and Agreement	Participants agreed that mature CVA systems provide the rapid-financing trigger required to move from forecast to action, transforming early-warning data into immediate cash support for at-risk populations.
Implications for CVA & PPP Implementation	Positions CVA as the operational enabler of AA, requiring strong readiness before shocks occur rather than reactive deployment.
Integration of Preparedness, CVA and AA	
Key Insight and Agreement	While linkages between preparedness, CVA and AA are improving, implementation timelines remain fragmented and often out of sync.
Implications for CVA & PPP Implementation	Highlights the need for stronger coordination mechanisms and joint planning to enable a seamless, “ready-to-activate” response.
Embedding AA in National DRR/DRM Governance	
Key Insight and Agreement	AA protocols developed in contexts such as Chad and South Sudan must be formally embedded within national disaster-risk legislation, budgeting cycles and coordination structures.
Implications for CVA & PPP Implementation	Ensures sustainability, government ownership, and scalability of AA beyond project-based implementation.
Core-System Investment in Pilot Approaches	
Key Insight and Agreement	National Societies emphasized prioritizing sustained investment in CVA core systems—data platforms, SOPs, and training pipelines—rather than isolated pilot initiatives.
Implications for CVA & PPP Implementation	Strengthens institutional readiness and avoids fragmentation, enabling predictable and scalable CVA delivery.
Government Advocacy through CVA Pilots (Eswatini)	
Key Insight and Agreement	Successful CVA pilots demonstrated the effectiveness of cash, helping to overcome initial governmental resistance and encouraging state adoption of cash within social protection schemes.
Implications for CVA & PPP Implementation	Demonstrates CVA’s role as an advocacy and systems-change tool, influencing national policy and programming.
Cross-Result Synergies	

Key Insight and Agreement	CVA enabled flexible financing across health, livelihoods and migration responses, reinforcing outcomes across multiple PPP result areas.
Implications for CVA & PPP Implementation	Confirms CVA's cross-cutting value and contribution to overall PPP coherence and impact
Overall: The Dubai workshop provided a strategic reflection point for National Societies and partners on the evolving role of Cash and Voucher Assistance (CVA) within preparedness and Anticipatory Action (AA). Discussions emphasized CVA's function as a core operational system—rather than a standalone modality—capable of translating early-warning information into rapid, flexible assistance.	

Looking Forward:

As the ECHO Pilot Programmatic Partnership concludes, the institutional and operational foundations established under Result 4 provide a strong platform for sustained and scalable Cash and Voucher Assistance (CVA) delivery across the IFRC network.

The PPP has shifted CVA from a project-based modality to a core institutional system within participating National Societies. Investments in digital platforms, framework agreements with Financial Service Providers (FSPs), standardized SOPs, trained focal points, and coordination mechanisms have embedded cash readiness within national structures. These systems now enable National Societies to activate CVA rapidly in response to new crises without requiring foundational rebuilding.

Looking ahead, several strategic priorities will guide continued progress:

1. Institutional Consolidation:

National Societies will continue integrating CVA into their strategic plans, contingency frameworks, and disaster risk management systems, ensuring sustainability beyond donor-specific funding cycles.

2. Digital Interoperability and System Integration:

Further strengthening linkages between RedRose, 121 Platform, EspoCRM, and national systems will enhance efficiency, audit readiness, and scalability. Continued digital maturity assessments will guide tailored transformation pathways.

3. Anticipatory Action Integration:

Building on lessons from the Dubai workshop, CVA systems will increasingly function as financing triggers within anticipatory action protocols, embedding early-warning-to-cash pipelines within national disaster governance structures.

4. Government and Social Protection Alignment:

Successful pilots have demonstrated CVA's value in influencing national policy.

Continued advocacy and alignment with government-led social protection mechanisms will further institutionalize cash within national response systems.

5. Network-wide Knowledge Sharing:

Regional Communities of Practice and Cash Working Groups will remain key drivers of peer learning, harmonization, and standard setting across the IFRC network.

The PPP has demonstrated that when core systems are strengthened, National Societies can transition from reactive cash delivery to proactive, predictable, and coordinated CVA responses. The legacy of Result 4 lies not only in the assistance delivered during the programme, but in the durable institutional capacity now embedded within the Movement.

Conclusion:

The ECHO Pilot Programmatic Partnership demonstrated that investing in **CVA capacity under Result 4** significantly strengthened the overall quality, speed, and reach of the programme. By building digital systems, financial service partnerships, and staff capacity, result 4 enabled National Societies to deliver timely, efficient, and dignified assistance across all pillars.

CVA became a core modality supporting disaster preparedness, health and epidemic response, migration and displacement, and long-term National Society development. These investments reduced transfer times, improved data accuracy and accountability, and ensured assistance could be delivered even in complex environments.

Across 21 National Societies, the PPP applied CVA in multiple sectors—multi-purpose cash, health, shelter, WASH, livelihoods, protection, and migration—allowing households to quickly meet their most urgent needs while strengthening resilience and recovery.

Result 4 also drove institutional change. National Societies adopted digital systems, finalized SOPs and roadmaps, trained staff, and enhanced coordination through Cash Working Groups and regional exchanges. These gains have positioned them as “cash-ready” actors with sustainable capacity beyond the PPP period.

Overall, Result 4 acted as a backbone of the PPP, enabling faster responses, stronger accountability, and more dignified, people-centred assistance—demonstrating clear added value and lasting impact for communities and the wider humanitarian system.

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